PPA Speech Therapy Suite

Therapist & Caregiver User Guide

Designed for people with Primary Progressive Aphasia (PPA)
and their speech-language pathologists and caregivers.

Version 4 • March 2026

Introduction

PPA Speech Therapy Suite is a browser-based application that provides structured speech therapy exercises for people with Primary Progressive Aphasia (PPA). It combines AI-powered conversation with focused practice tools covering word-finding, repetition, sentence construction, script training, and video comprehension.

The app is designed to be used both in therapy sessions and independently at home. A therapist or caregiver can customise the exercises using the Admin Panel behind a PIN.

🧠 **About Dr. Aria**

All AI responses in the application come from Dr. Aria — a compassionate, patient AI speech-language pathologist. Dr. Aria always uses clear, simple language and celebrates every success.

The Nine Modules

Icon	Module	What it does
🧠	**AI Therapist**	Open conversation with Dr. Aria — for support, questions, and general practice
📋	**Assessment**	Structured tasks to evaluate word-finding, repetition, and reading abilities
🏷️	**Naming Practice**	Name pictures with adaptive spaced repetition; AI cues and progress tracking
🔄	**Repetition**	Repeat words, phrases, and sentences of increasing length
💬	**Script Training**	Practise set phrases for real-life situations (doctor, phone, public)
🔤	**Sentence Builder**	Build sentences by selecting words from a visual word bank
📝	**Sentence Work**	Complete and construct sentences with structured prompts
🎬	**Video Questions**	Watch a short video clip and answer WHO / WHAT / WHERE questions
📈	**Progress**	View activity charts and generate a clinical progress report

Getting Started

Opening the Application

The app opens to the AI Therapist module. The sidebar on the left lets you switch between all nine modules at any time. There is no login required.

> 💡 **First session**
>
> Start with the AI Therapist to let Dr. Aria introduce herself and understand how you are feeling. Then try Naming Practice or Repetition for structured exercise.

Navigating the App

- Click any module name in the left sidebar to switch to it.
- Your place in an exercise is not saved when you switch modules — complete an exercise before switching.
- The header shows a 💾 Backup recommended button (amber) when your content has changed since the last backup. Click it to download a backup immediately.

Module Guides

🧠 AI Therapist

Have a free-flowing conversation with Dr. Aria. You can type your message or speak aloud and then type what you said. Dr. Aria remembers everything in the current session — ask about symptoms, request exercises, or just talk.

> 💡 **Tip for caregivers**
> You can ask Dr. Aria for advice on supporting a person with PPA, or ask it to explain what a particular exercise type does.

📋 Assessment

The Assessment module presents language evaluation tasks covering naming, repetition, reading aloud, and comprehension. Dr. Aria evaluates responses and provides clinical feedback.

- Work through each task at your own pace.
- Results are logged to the Progress module automatically.

🏷️ Naming Practice

A picture or word card is shown. Try to name it. If the word is on the tip of your tongue, press the Space bar while the answer box is empty — each press reveals one more letter from the start of the word (e.g. A…, AP…, APP…). For more support, use the cue buttons:

- **Semantic Cue** — a description or category hint (e.g. 'It\'s a fruit you eat').
- **Phonemic Cue** — the first sound or syllable (e.g. 'Starts with A...').
- **Reveal** — shows the answer.

Answer box during hints: A text input field remains visible when a hint is shown, so you can continue typing your answer at any cue level without losing what you have already typed.

Mark each attempt as Correct, Cued, or Incorrect using the buttons. Your score is tracked in Progress.

> ✨ **Spaced Repetition — smarter practice order**
> Naming Practice now uses a PPA-adapted spaced repetition algorithm to choose which word to show next. Instead of always starting from the beginning, the app presents words based on how well you have been doing with each one.
>
> How it works:
>
> - Words you got **correct** are shown again after a slightly longer gap.

- Words where you used the **Space bar starter** come back with a very slight step back — you needed a nudge, but less than a full hint.
- Words that needed a **semantic cue** stay at the same interval — stable but not yet mastered.
- Words that needed a **phonemic cue** or the full **reveal** are reviewed sooner.
- No word is ever delayed more than **5 days** — because PPA is progressive, everything is reviewed at least every five days.

A status bar above the cards shows how many words are due for review and, for the current word, how it went last time. The first time the module is opened, your full session history is used to set a sensible starting schedule automatically.

💡 **Admin — customise items**

Open the admin panel (⚙️ gear icon, PIN 1234) to add your own naming items with custom graphics, cues, and categories. You can also export items to a .ppa file and import them on another device.

Adding Graphics to Naming Items

When adding or editing a naming item in the admin panel, click Change graphic to open the graphic picker. There are four tabs:

- 🎨 **Pick emoji** — choose from categorised emoji sets.
- ⌨️ **Type emoji** — paste or type any emoji directly.
- 📁 **Upload photo** — upload a local image file from your device. Supports JPEG, PNG, WebP, HEIC, GIF, and most other formats. You can also drag a photo directly from a Finder window or the Photos app onto the drop zone.
- 🔗 **Image URL** — paste a web address for an online image.

💡 **Using Mac Photos Library**

If the file picker sidebar shows 'No Library Found' when you click on Photos, your browser has not yet been granted access. Two workarounds:

- **Drag & drop:** open the Photos app, select a photo, and drag it directly onto the upload drop zone.
- **Export first:** in Photos, select a photo → File → Export → Export Photo, save it to the Desktop, then click the drop zone and pick the saved file.

To fix the sidebar permanently: **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Photos** → enable your browser.

🔄 Repetition

Practise repeating words and phrases. Three built-in levels are included:

- **Level 1: Single Words** — short, common words
- **Level 2: Short Phrases** — 2–4 word phrases
- **Level 3: Sentences** — complete sentences of increasing complexity

Press 🔊 to hear the item read aloud, then try to repeat it. Mark it Correct or Incorrect.

> 💡 **Admin — add levels**
> Open the admin panel to add custom levels with your own words or phrases. Useful for targeting specific vocabulary relevant to the patient.

💬 Script Training

Script Training teaches set phrases for common real-life situations. Built-in situations include:

- At the doctor
- At home
- On the phone
- In public

For each phrase, press 🔊 to hear it, then practise saying it aloud. The 'I have aphasia. I understand more than I can say.' phrase in the In Public situation is particularly useful in everyday communication.

> 💡 **Admin — add situations**
> Add custom situations and phrases relevant to the patient's life, such as phrases for a favourite restaurant or a family member's name.

🔤 Sentence Builder

Build sentences by selecting words from a categorised word bank. Words appear as coloured chips. Click a word chip to add it to your sentence. Use the three buttons on the right:

- 🔊 **Speak** — reads your sentence aloud
- 🗑️ **Clear** — removes all words from the sentence
- 💾 **Save** — adds the sentence to your saved library

The word bank is organised by category: Nouns, Verbs, Adjectives, Adverbs, Pronouns, Prepositions, and Articles. A search box at the top filters all categories at once.

📝 Sentence Work

Two types of exercise:

- **Completions** — a sentence with a blank; choose the correct word from options.
- **Constructions** — arrange given words into a correct sentence.

After answering, Dr. Aria gives feedback. Your results are logged to Progress.

🎬 Video Questions

Watching the video

A short video clip plays in the player. Watch the whole clip, then press 'I'm Ready — Answer Questions →' to begin.

Answering questions

Three questions appear one at a time — WHO, WHAT, and WHERE. Each question has four answer options. Select your answer, then press Confirm. After all three questions, press 'Next Video →' to move to the next clip. Dr. Aria gives encouraging feedback at the end of each round.

Selecting a different clip

Click the dropdown bar at the top of the module to see all available clips, grouped by difficulty (Easy, Medium, Hard) and a My Clips section for custom clips.

> 💡 **Admin — add your own clips**
>
> Open the admin panel (⚙️ gear icon, PIN 1234) and click '+ Add New Video Clip'. You can add a clip from:
>
> - **YouTube URL** — paste a YouTube link and set optional start/stop times.
> - **Local video file (.mp4)** — select a video file from your device.
>
> Enter a description of what happens in the video, choose a difficulty, then either write your own WHO/WHAT/WHERE questions or click 'Generate with AI' to have Dr. Aria create three questions from your description automatically.
>
> After saving, close the Import Video Clip panel (✕) to return to the clip list, then click Close to return to the Video Questions module.

> ✨ **Local video clips now persist reliably**
>
> Custom clips added from a local .mp4 file are now stored in the browser's IndexedDB (which has no size limit), while only the clip metadata is kept in localStorage. This means local-file clips survive navigation between modules without disappearing.

📈 Progress

Activity dashboard

The dashboard shows a heatmap of activity over the selected period (default: last 7 days). Each coloured square represents one day; darker colours mean more activity. A summary of activities per module is shown below the heatmap.

Progress report

Click 'Generate Report' to ask Dr. Aria to write a clinical narrative report based on the session log. The report covers activity patterns, areas of strength, and areas for continued focus. It can be copied to the clipboard or emailed.

Admin — Settings

Open the gear (⚙) in the Progress header with PIN 1234 to access:

- **Default reporting period** — the time window used for the dashboard and reports.
- **Email address** — included in the report header (the app does not send email itself).
- **Module detail levels** — controls how much detail appears per module in the AI report: Detailed, Summary, or None.
- **Backup & Restore** — download a full backup or restore from a previous backup file.
- **Clear progress data** — remove activity logs for a date range or clear all historical data.

Admin Panel

The admin panel lets therapists and caregivers customise the content in each module. It is available in seven of the nine modules via the ⚙️ gear button.

> 📋 **Default PIN**
>
> The admin PIN is 1234. This is the same for all modules. Contact whoever set up the app if you need to change it.

Entering the Admin Panel

1. Click the ⚙️ gear icon — usually in the top-right corner of the module area.
2. Type the four-digit PIN (default: 1234) and press Enter or click Confirm.
3. The admin view opens. Make your changes, then click Close or the ✕ button.

Exporting Content to a File

You can save your custom content to a .ppa file on your computer. This lets you move content between devices or keep a backup of just the content for one module.

4. Open the admin panel for the module.
5. Click the 📤 Export button in the toolbar.
6. Tick the items you want to export and type a filename. Click Export.
7. The file is saved as filename.ppa to your Downloads folder.

Importing Content from a File

8. Open the admin panel for the module.
9. Click the 📥 Import button and select one or more .ppa files.
10. Imported items are added to the list immediately.

> ⚠️ **Important**
>
> .ppa files are module-specific. A file exported from Naming Practice cannot be imported into Video Questions.

Backup & Restore

All your custom content and progress data is stored in your browser. It is not sent to any server. This means it could be lost if you clear your browser data. Regular backups are strongly recommended.

When to Back Up

- After adding or editing custom content in any module.
- When the amber '💾 Backup recommended' button appears in the app header.
- Before clearing browser data or switching to a new device.
- At the end of each therapy session.

Downloading a Full Backup

11. Click the amber '💾 Backup recommended' button in the app header — this downloads immediately. OR go to Progress → ⚙️ Settings → Backup & Restore → Download Full Backup.
12. The file is saved as ppa-therapy-backup-YYYY-MM-DD.ppabak to your Downloads folder.
13. Store this file somewhere safe — a cloud folder, or email it to yourself.

Restoring from a Backup

14. Go to Progress → ⚙️ Settings → Backup & Restore.
15. Click 'Restore from Backup File' and select your .ppabak file.
16. The app will reload with all your data restored.

> ⚠️ **Restore replaces all current data**
>
> Restoring a backup overwrites everything currently in the app with the contents of the backup file. Make sure you have a current backup before restoring an older one.

What the Backup Contains

- All custom naming items, repetition levels, scripts, and sentence exercises
- All custom video clips (including questions, YouTube references, local file metadata, and descriptions)
- Spaced repetition schedule for Naming Practice
- Your saved Sentence Builder library
- All progress activity logs
- Progress settings (report period, email, detail levels)
- Export tracking records

Tips for Effective Sessions

For People with PPA

- There is no time pressure. Take as long as you need before answering.
- Use the 🔊 Speak button whenever it is available — hearing the word helps.
- If you get a wrong answer, try again. Dr. Aria is never frustrated or impatient.
- Start with easier exercises and work up when you feel ready.
- Script Training phrases are useful to practise before real-life situations — a doctor's appointment, a phone call.
- In Naming Practice, the app will bring back words you found hard more quickly, and give more time before showing words you have been getting right. You do not need to restart from the beginning — just keep going.

For Therapists

- Use the Naming Practice admin panel to build a custom word set targeted at the patient's specific areas of difficulty.
- Add video clips that are personally meaningful — a favourite hobby, familiar places, family activities.
- Use the Progress Report as a starting point for session notes — generate it, copy the text, and edit as needed.
- The Script Training module works best when custom phrases match the patient's daily vocabulary and communication needs.
- Export module content to .ppa files to share exercises between patients (remove personal data first) or to keep versioned backups of specific exercise sets.
- The spaced repetition schedule in Naming Practice is stored separately (ppa_naming_sr in browser storage) and is included in the full backup. If you restore a backup, the schedule is restored too.

For Caregivers

- You can sit alongside the person and use the AI Therapist together — type questions on their behalf or have them dictate and you type.
- Download a backup after every session so progress is never lost.
- The Progress heatmap is a quick way to see which days have been most active — useful for tracking engagement over time.

Troubleshooting

Dr. Aria is not responding

- Check your internet connection — the app needs internet to contact the AI.
- Try refreshing the page. Note: the AI Therapist conversation will restart.

A custom video clip is missing after switching modules

This was a known issue in earlier versions. It has been fixed: local-file clips are now stored in IndexedDB and survive navigation. If you have an older backup that still shows the issue, re-adding the clip will persist it correctly going forward. YouTube-based clips are unaffected.

Mac Photos Library shows 'No Library Found'

The browser needs permission to access your Mac Photos Library. If that permission was never granted, macOS reports no library instead of prompting. Two workarounds that do not require changing permissions:

17. **Drag & drop:** open the Photos app, select a photo, and drag it onto the upload drop zone in the Graphic Picker.
18. **Export first:** in Photos, select a photo → File → Export → Export Photo → save to Desktop → click the drop zone and select the saved file.

Permanent fix: System Settings → Privacy & Security → Photos → enable your browser.

The Naming Practice app is showing words I just practised

The spaced repetition scheduler shows words in priority order — most overdue first, then new words, then upcoming ones. If several words are all due on the same day, they may appear close together. This is normal and intentional. Words you answer correctly will be spaced further out on subsequent sessions.

The app is slow or freezing

- Large amounts of progress data (many months of daily use) may affect performance. Consider clearing older progress logs from Progress → ⚙ Settings → Clear Progress Data.
- Close other browser tabs to free memory.

My data is gone after clearing the browser

All app data is stored in the browser's localStorage and IndexedDB. Clearing site data or browser storage will erase it. This is why regular backups are essential. If you have a .ppabak file, you can restore it from Progress → ⚙ Settings → Backup & Restore.

The backup file says it is not a valid .ppabak file

- Make sure you are selecting a file that ends with .ppabak (not .ppa).
- The file must not have been renamed or opened and re-saved in a text editor.